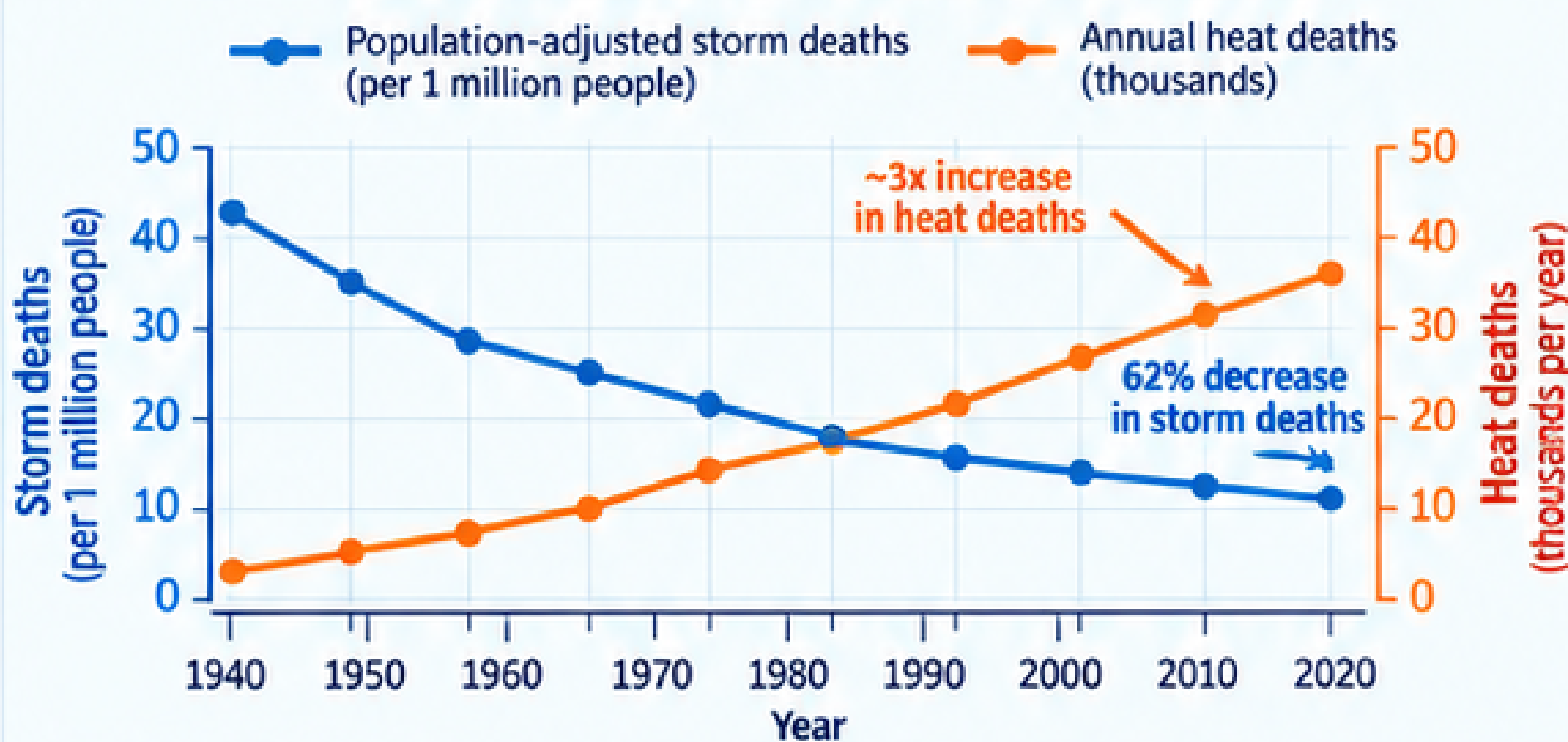


The Survival Illusion: What Falling Storm Fatalities Hide

Declining storm deaths look like an adaptation victory. In reality, Americans are surviving by retreating while ambient temperature mortality surges.

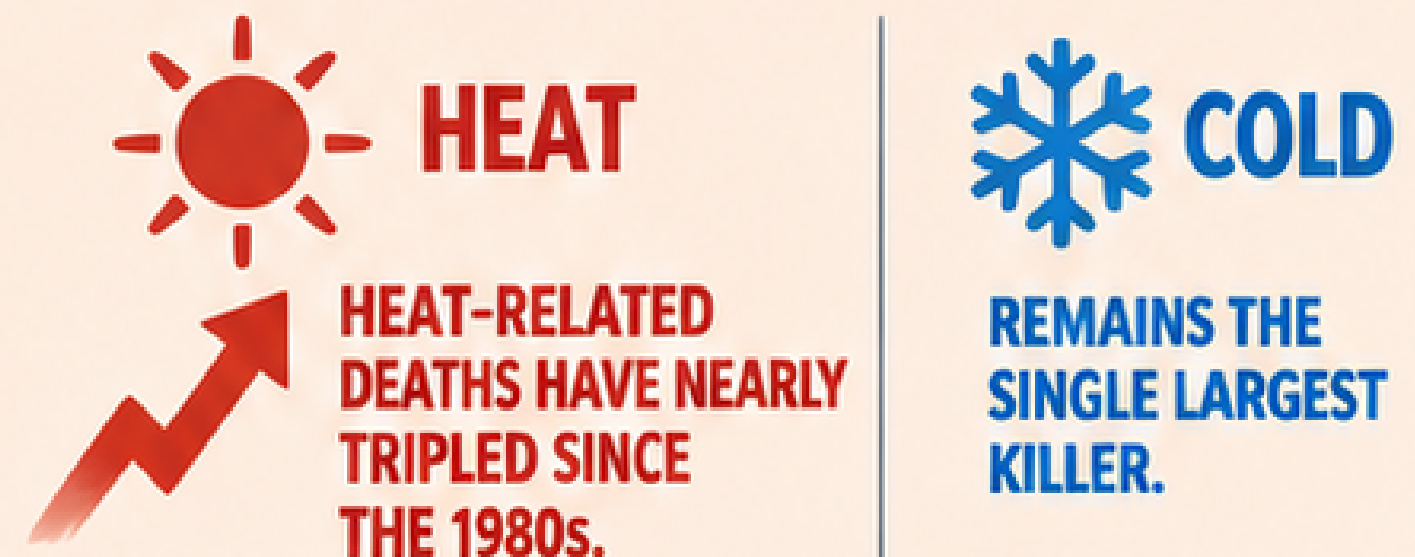
1 The False Victory

Storm Deaths vs. Annual Heat Deaths



- Population-adjusted storm deaths fell 62% over 80 years.
- This apparent victory is misleading.
- Loud storms make headlines, but quiet thermal extremes are the real threat.

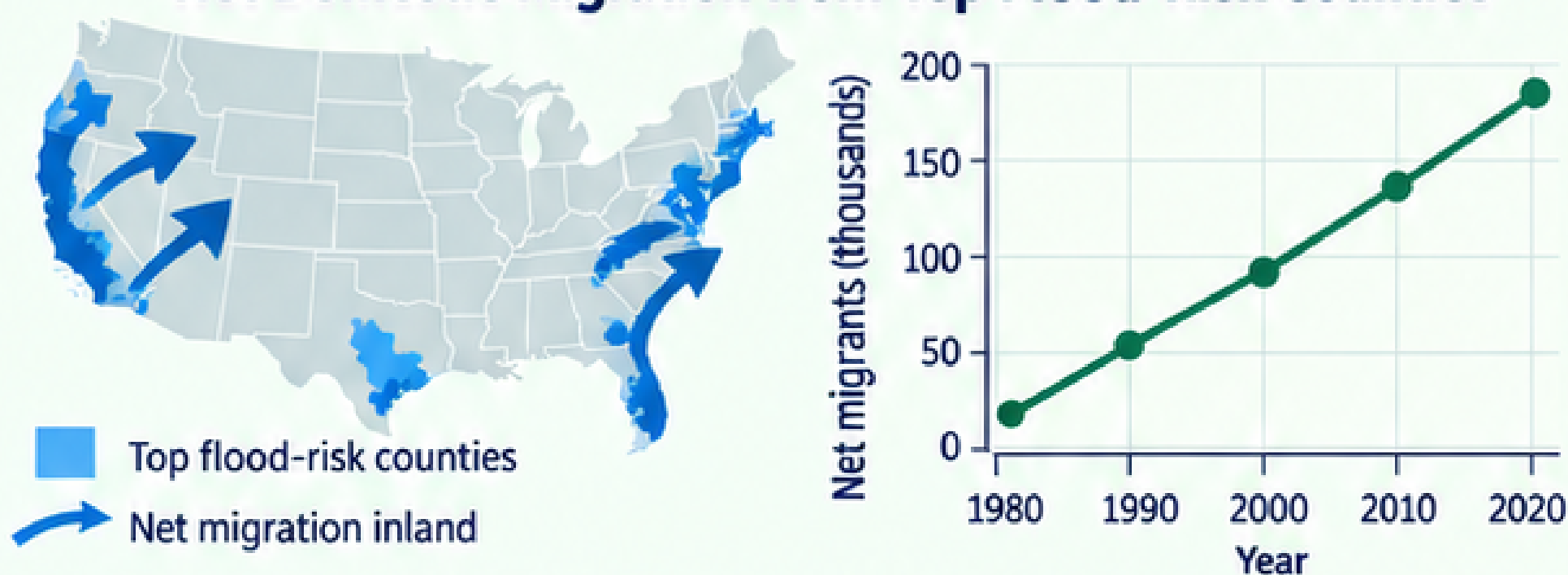
2 The Rising Ambient Threat



- Heat-related deaths have nearly tripled since the 1980s.
- Non-optimal ambient temperatures cause 5% to 12% of all global deaths.
- Cold remains the single largest killer, while heat vulnerability accelerates rapidly.
- Public policy obsesses over kinetic storms while thousands die from thermal stress inside their homes.

3 Survival by Retreat

Net Domestic Migration from Top Flood-Risk Counties



- Falling storm mortality is driven by geographic avoidance, not engineering invincibility.
- Families are actively fleeing low-lying coastal flood zones as insurance and repair costs spike.
- Capital turns over roughly 2% annually as structures depreciate.
- Relocating worn-out assets inland costs under 0.01% of GDP per year.
- Adaptation succeeds when society steps out of the hazard's path.

4 "Hold On!"



- Rising temperature mortality does not necessarily mean adaptation failed.
- Populations in developed nations are aging rapidly.
- An expanding elderly cohort mechanically inflates baseline thermal vulnerability.
- Demographics may be masking genuine technological progress.